

# PLAYER HANDBOOK

Character creation, simple rules, kindreds, jobs, spells, gear, and a worked example

## THISTLEBRIGHT ADVENTURES

Scottish fairy myth, high fantasy, safe wonder, and table rules made for brave young players.



# How to use this book

1. Choose who helps as the Guide.
2. Make a hero in five easy steps.
3. Use Brave, Kind, and Quick when a roll is exciting.
4. Keep the story warm: heroes can be muddy, surprised, or silly, but never shamed.



**Table feel:** point at the picture, ask what the hero notices, then roll only when it is exciting.

**For ages 5–7:** read choices aloud, let children point to pictures, and use stars or stickers for stats instead of lots of numbers.

## What you need

- One six-sided die.
- A pencil, character sheet, and three little counters.
- A grown-up or older sibling Guide.
- A promise to listen and take turns.

## What players say

- “I help.”
- “I try the brave thing.”
- “Can I talk to it?”
- “I look closer.”
- “Can my friend help?”

### First table promise

Every player gets a turn to say one idea before the dice decide anything.





## WELCOME TO THE GLEN

Tiny bells ring beneath the heather. A fairy guide invites the heroes to help a magical place without making the rules too big.



# THE EASY DICE RULE

When the answer is obvious, no roll is needed. When everyone leans forward and wonders what might happen, roll one six-sided die and add the hero's matching stat stars.

| Total | Result         | Say it like this                              |
|-------|----------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| 1–2   | Wobble         | It goes wrong in a funny, safe, or messy way. |
| 3–4   | Yes, but...    | It works, and there is a tiny cost or choice. |
| 5+    | Bright success | It works well, and the hero feels proud.      |

**No failure spiral:** a wobble changes the scene; it does not stop the adventure.

## The three stats

- **Brave** — standing tall, protecting, climbing, daring, saying “I can try.”
- **Kind** — helping, calming, sharing, talking, understanding feelings.
- **Quick** — sneaking, catching, dodging, spotting, balancing.

## When not to roll

- The action is safe and obvious.
- A child is only describing how they look or feel.
- The group already found a kind solution.
- A roll would slow a warm moment.

### Helping rule

If another hero clearly helps, add +1 or let the child roll again and choose the better die.



# STAT CREATION

## Step 1: Pick your best stat

Put ★★ in the thing your hero is best at.

## Step 2: Pick your okay stat

Put ★ in the thing your hero can usually do.

## Step 3: Leave one blank

Put — in the thing your hero is still learning. This is not bad; it makes stories fun.

**Example:** Rowan the Beast Friend has Kind ★★, Quick ★, Brave —. Rowan talks gently to foxes, moves carefully, and is still learning to be bold.

**Helper question:** “Which one sounds most like your hero: brave, kind, or quick?”

### If a child wants all ★★

Say: “Every hero is still learning something. Which one will be funny to practise?”

### If a child worries about —

Say: “Blank means story chance, not bad. Friends can help you.”

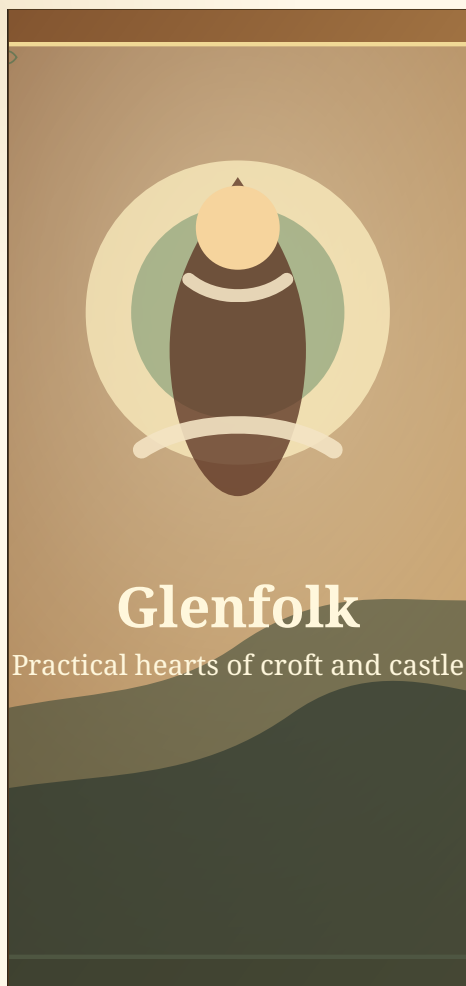




## STEP 1: PICK YOUR KINDRED

Each kindred now has its own illustrated page. Let children point at the picture first, then read only the choices they need.





KINDRED

## GLENFOLK

**G**lenfolk are croft, cottage, castle, and market-lane children with practical hearts. They know how to ask neighbours, find a dry path, and make ordinary things feel brave.

### Story gift

Once per adventure, remember a local clue or helpful person.

### Look

- Tartan scarf, muddy boots, treasure pockets.
- A wooden badge, snack cloth, or tiny family charm.

### Good at the table

- Ask an auntie, shepherd, baker, guard, or gardener for help.
- Know what a tool is called or where a path should go.
- Offer practical kindness: a snack, blanket, or fixed latch.

### Best first stat

Kind or Quick

### First scene idea

A village gate is stuck and everyone has an idea.

### Say this

*"I know someone who might help."*





KINDRED

## THISTLE FAIRY

**T**histle Fairies are small bright folk with manners, shimmer, and secret paths. They are excellent at noticing fairy marks that bigger people step over.

### Story gift

Once per scene, notice nearby fairy magic.

### Look

- Petal cloak, star freckles, tiny crown.
- Boots that never quite touch the puddles.

### Good at the table

- Ask flowers, moths, or beetles for tiny gossip.
- Spot a hidden ring of mushrooms or a polite fairy door.
- Remember an old rule of fairy manners.

### Best first stat

Quick

### First scene idea

A secret flower-door opens only after a polite greeting.

### Say this

*"I bow politely and look for the sparkle."*





KINDRED

## BROWNIE HELPER

**B**rownie Helpers are cozy fixers who tidy, mend, and improve small things. They turn a messy room, broken spoon, or squeaky hinge into a clue.

### Story gift

Repair or improve one tiny object each scene.

### Look

- Apron, tool pouch, flour on nose.
- Buttons, string, thimble hat, or polished spoon.

### Good at the table

- Fix a latch, mend a pouch, clean mud from a clue.
- Find the important thing hiding in a pile of mess.
- Make a worried home feel safe again.

### Best first stat

Kind

### First scene idea

A kitchen clue is hidden under a very silly mess.

### Say this

*"I can fix the little thing first."*



KINDRED

## SELKIE-BORN

**S**elkie-Born heroes have gentle loch-hearts and moonlit dreams. They understand water, weather, and the soft feelings people hide under their coats.

### Story gift

Understand water, weather, or a sad feeling.

### Look

- Soft seal-cloak, shell button, sea-glass charm.
- Wet curls, quiet eyes, and pockets full of smooth stones.

### Good at the table

- Hear what rain, waves, or a puddle is trying to say.
- Comfort a lonely creature without many words.
- Find a safe way across shallow water.

### Best first stat

Kind

### First scene idea

A sad loch-creature will only speak to someone gentle.

### Say this

*"I listen to the loch before I answer."*





KINDRED

## ROWAN-KIN

**R**owan-Kin are forest children with leaf crowns and careful listening. Old trees remember them, birds trust them, and red berries mark their promises.

### Story gift

Ask a tree, bird, or breeze for one hint.

### Look

- Red berries, green cloak, bark-pattern gloves.
- Leaf crown, acorn buttons, or a walking twig.

### Good at the table

- Read bent grass, scratched bark, or a bird alarm.
- Ask an old tree who passed this way.
- Hide gently among leaves without frightening anyone.

### Best first stat

Quick

### First scene idea

An old tree remembers the wrong name and needs patient listening.

### Say this

*"I ask the old tree what it remembers."*



KINDRED

## HEATHER GIANTLING

**H**eather Giantlings are small for giants, huge for fairies, and very gentle. They are best when something heavy, high, or frightening needs a careful friend.

### Story gift

Lift, push, or carry one heavy thing safely.

### Look

- Big knitted jumper, pebble buttons, warm laugh.
- Purple heather in hair and boots like little boats.

### Good at the table

- Hold a door, carry a tired friend, or move a fallen branch.
- Stand calmly when a noise is big.
- Ask hills, stones, or goats about family stories.

### Best first stat

Brave

### First scene idea

A fallen branch blocks the path, but small animals live underneath.

### Say this

*"I can be big and gentle at the same time."*





## STEP 2: PICK YOUR ADVENTURE JOB

Each job now has its own illustrated page. The job says what a hero likes doing when trouble appears.





ADVENTURE JOB

## THISTLE KNIGHT

**T**histle Knights protect friends and stand bravely at the front. They are not rough or bossy; they make scary moments feel safer for everyone.

### Gift

Once per scene, turn a scary moment into a brave one.

### Best stat

Brave

### Try this

- Hold a shield or walking stick like a promise.
- Stand between danger and a friend.
- Say a brave sentence out loud.

### Starter kit

- Soft shield
- Promise ribbon
- Thistle badge

### Say this

*"I stand tall so my friend can try."*

### Team role

This job shines most when it helps another hero have a turn.





ADVENTURE JOB

## LOCH SCOUT

**L**och Scouts find paths, listen for clues, and spot hidden doors. They love maps, footprints, bird calls, and the first tiny sign that something changed.

### Gift

Ask the Guide one “what do I notice?” question.

### Best stat

Quick

### Try this

- Follow tracks through reeds or heather.
- Read a map or remember a landmark.
- Balance across stepping stones.

### Starter kit

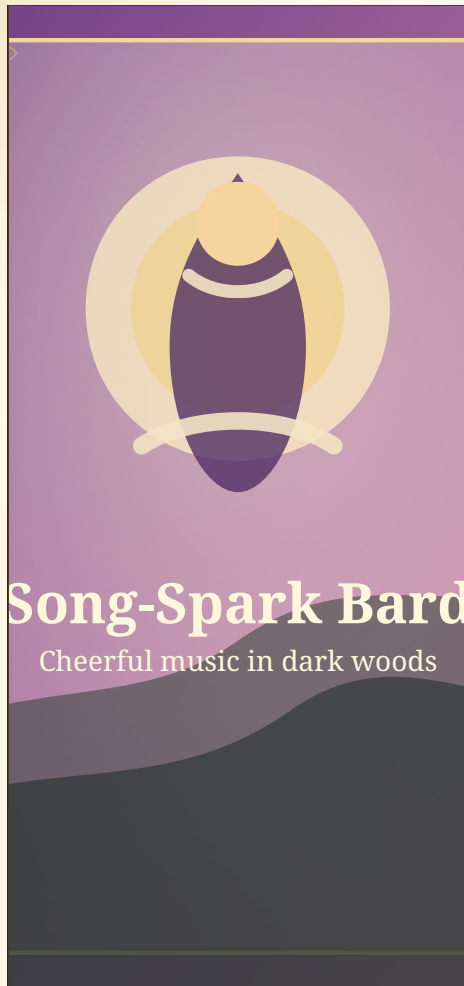
- Chalk
- String map
- Tiny lantern

### Say this

*“I look closely before we move.”*

### Team role

This job shines most when it helps another hero have a turn.



ADVENTURE JOB

## SONG-SPARK BARD

**S**ong-Spark Bards use music, jokes, and stories to lift everyone up. Their magic is cheer, rhythm, and the courage that comes from being heard.

### Gift

Give another hero +1 after a kind song, rhyme, joke, or cheer.

### Best stat

Kind

### Try this

- Cheer a friend who feels unsure.
- Calm a crowd with a rhyme.
- Make a grumpy bridge laugh politely.

### Starter kit

- Bell
- Ribbon drum
- Story cards

### Say this

*"I sing the brave bit for you."*

### Team role

This job shines most when it helps another hero have a turn.





ADVENTURE JOB

## HEARTH MAGE

**H**earth Mages carry warm, safe magic: sparks, steam, tea, and tiny lights. Their spells help problems; they do not solve the whole story alone.

### Gift

Create a small helpful magical effect.

### Best stat

Kind or Brave

### Try this

- Light a path with a glow-pebble.
- Warm cold hands with tea-steam.
- Reveal a hidden breeze or fairy mark.

### Starter kit

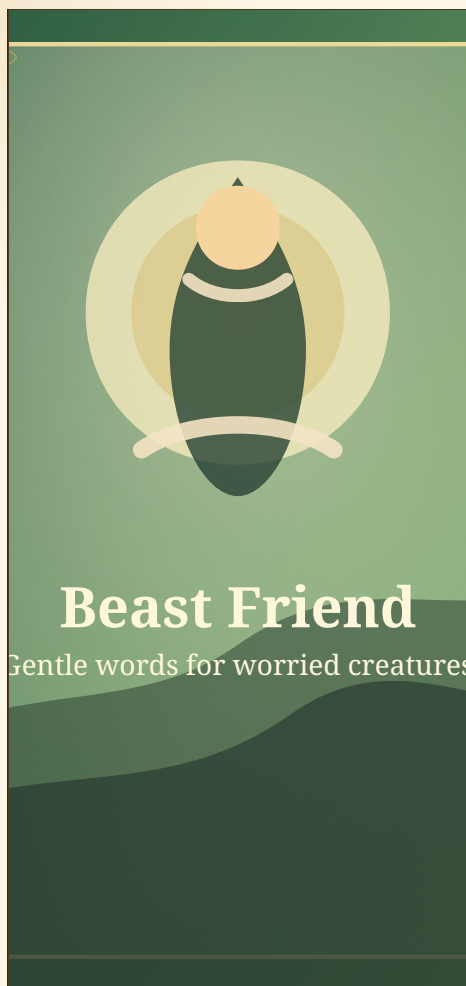
- Teacup
- Glow pebble
- Little spoon wand

### Say this

*"A tiny warm spell might help."*

### Team role

This job shines most when it helps another hero have a turn.



ADVENTURE JOB

## BEAST FRIEND

**B**east Friends understand animals and earn trust with gentle patience. They notice tails, ears, paws, feathers, and feelings before they roll dice.

### Gift

Ask a friendly creature for a small favor.

### Best stat

Kind

### Try this

- Offer a snack without grabbing.
- Copy a small sound politely.
- Ask what the creature feels.

### Starter kit

- Oat pouch
- Soft brush
- Kindness bell

### Say this

*"I crouch down and speak gently."*

### Team role

This job shines most when it helps another hero have a turn.



ADVENTURE JOB

## PUZZLE TINKER

**P**uzzle Tinkers build, open, balance, fold, and wonder how things work. They like ordinary bits: string, cups, buttons, chalk, and clever questions.

### Gift

Make a simple tool from ordinary bits.

### Best stat

Quick

### Try this

- Fix a latch or squeaky hinge.
- Build a tiny bridge from safe pieces.
- Turn clues into a simple plan.

### Starter kit

- String
- Chalk
- Button box

### Say this

*“What if this little thing fits here?”*

### Team role

This job shines most when it helps another hero have a turn.



# SPILLS, GEAR, AND TREASURE



**Rule:** magic helps the story; it does not solve every problem alone.

## Safe little spells

- **Glow-pebble:** make a small light.
- **Tea-steam:** warm cold hands or reveal a breeze.
- **Thistle-tickle:** distract a grumpy creature for a moment.
- **Kind whisper:** help someone say what they feel.
- **Button-bridge:** make a tiny bridge for one small creature.
- **Heather-hush:** quiet a noisy room for one careful question.

### Spell limit

A spell can help one small problem. Big problems still need friends, ideas, and choices.

## Starting gear

- A snack wrapped in cloth.
- One useful tool.
- One pretty charm.
- One thing your hero drew themselves.
- A spare ribbon, button, bell, shell, or smooth stone.
- A tiny notebook for clues or doodles.

## Useful tools

| Tool       | Use                            |
|------------|--------------------------------|
| Lantern    | See misty paths.               |
| String     | Tie, measure, or rescue.       |
| Chalk      | Mark a safe way back.          |
| Wooden cup | Offer water, tea, or kindness. |

## Treasure prompts

| Find          | Story use               |
|---------------|-------------------------|
| Silver button | Opens a promise gate.   |
| Ribbon        | Marks a safe path.      |
| Bell          | Calls one fairy friend. |

**Treasure is story-first:** a shiny button can matter more than a bag of coins if it unlocks a promise.

# MAKING A HERO: QUICK CHECKLIST

1. Name your hero.
2. Pick a kindred.
3. Pick an adventure job.
4. Choose stats: ★★, ★, and —.
5. Pick one gear item and one charm.
6. Answer: “Who do I want to help?”

**Worked example:** Rowan Moonbutton is a Selkie-Born Beast Friend. Stats: Kind ★★, Quick ★, Brave —. Gear: oat pouch. Charm: sea-glass button. Rowan wants to help nervous animals.

**Grown-up tip:** do not quiz a child on rules. Ask what they imagine, then translate that into Brave, Kind, or Quick.

## End of session

Ask: “Who did we help?” “What should we draw?”  
“What promise did we make?”

## Tiny advancement

After three adventures, add one sticker beside a gift. The sticker is a memory, not a new complicated rule.

## If a player is stuck

Offer two choices: “Do you want to talk kindly, move quickly, or do the brave thing?”

## If the group gets loud

Point to the picture, name one sound in the scene, then ask one child what their hero notices.